MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FIRING ATTACHMENT, BLANK AMMO: M20

This specification is approved for use within the U.S. Army Armament Munitions and Chemical Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the Firing Attachment, Blank Ammo: M20 for use with the M85 Machine Gun.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-W-63150 - Weapons and Support Materiel Standard Quality Assurance Provisions for

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander,U.S. Army Armament,Munitions and Chemical Command,Attn AMSMC-QA, Picatinny Arsenal, New Jersey 07806-5000 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD) Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect of the date of solicitation.

DRAWINGS

US ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT AND ENGINEERING CENTER (ARDEC)

Product and Packaging Drawings

9327231	- Firing Attachment, Blank Ammo: M20
P9327231	- Firing Attachment, Blank Ammo, M20, Packaging Data Sheet

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the Contracting Officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Materials shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Blank firing attachment. The blank firing attachment (BFA) shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (dwg.) 9327231, all associated drawings and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications and standards.

3.3 Assembleability. The blank firing attachment shall readily attach to and detach from the M85 machine gun or a fixture simulating the machine gun. When attached to the M85 machine gun or fixture, it shall be securely retained.

3.4 Functioning. When assembled to an M85 machine gun, the blank firing attachment shall permit the weapon to function properly. When eighty-five (85) cartridges are fired in the M85 machine gun there shall be no more than one (1) stoppage or malfunction directly attributable to the blank firing attachment.

3.5 First article inspection. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with the technical provisions herein (see 4.3 and 6.2.d).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.6 Workmanship. All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated and assembled in a thorough, workmanlike manner. They shall be free of burrs, chips, sharp edges, cracks, surface defects, dirt, oil, grease, rust, corrosion products, and other foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any part, nor shall the parts be contaminated by any cleaning agent. All required workings shall be neat and sharply defined.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may utilize his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of any defective material.

4.1 Classification of inspections. The following type of inspection shall apply:

a. First Article Inspection.

b. Quality Conformance Inspection.

4.3 First article sample.

4.3.1 Submission. The contractor shall submit a first article as designated by the contracting officer for evaluation in accordance with the provisions of 4.3.2. The first article sample shall consist of the following items in sample quantities as indicated:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Part descriptions	Drawings	Quantity
Firing attachment, Blank Ammo: M20	9327231	25

4.3.2 Inspections to be performed. First article assemblies and components shall be subjected to any or all of the examinations and tests specified in Table I and to any or all requirements of the applicable drawings.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE 1. First article inspection

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-F-63378A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 9327231
	Firing Attachment, Blank Ammo: M20				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Firing Attachment, Blank Ammo: M20 (Dwg. 9327231)				
	Examination for defects	25		3.2,3.6	4.4.2.1
	Assembleability	25		3.3	4.5.1
	Functioning Test	25		3.4	4.5.2

NOTES:

AMSMC Form 1570, 1 Feb 85 Replaces DRSMC-QA(D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83, which may not be used.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil - Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.3 Rejection. The first article quantity shall be rejected upon failure of any assembly or component in the sample to comply with any visual or dimensional characteristic or upon failure to comply with the criteria for any test. The Government reserves the right to terminate its inspection whenever a component or assembly fails to comply with any visual or dimensional characteristic or components or assemblies fail to comply with the criteria for any test.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Inspection lot formation. The term “inspection lot” is defined as a homogeneous collection of units of product from which a representative sample is drawn or which is inspected 100 percent to determine conformance with applicable requirements. Units of product selected for inspection shall represent only the inspection lot from which drawn and shall not be constructed to represent any prior or subsequent quantities presented for inspection. The inspection lot shall comply with the provisions for submission of product as specified in MIL-STD-105. All material submitted for inspection in accordance with this specification shall comply with the homogeneity criteria specified herein, regardless of the type of inspection procedure which is being applied to determine conformance with requirements. A lot shall consist of:

Parts produced by one manufacturer, in one unchanged process, in accordance with the same drawing and drawing revision, and same specification and specification revision.

4.4.2 Examination. Unless otherwise specified in the classification of defects and tests tables, sampling plans for the individual major and minor defects listed shall be in accordance with M1L-STD-105, Inspection Level II. Prior to the performance of the inspections and tests listed on the tables, the parts and assemblies comprising the blank firing attachment shall have been inspected in accordance with the applicable Quality Assurance Provisions.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-F-63378A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Blank Firing Attachment				9327231
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None defined				
Major					
101.	Rod spacer loose with respect to support		.65	3.2	Manual
102.	Torque of hex nut to rod spacer, improper		.65	3.2	SMTE
103.	Perpendicularity of rod spacer with noted surface of support		.65	3.2	SMTE
104.	Any part loose, improperly assembled or missing		.65	3.2	Visual/Manual
105.	Sealing compound missing from rod spacer		.65	3.2	Visual
Minor					
201.	Marking on support missing, incorrect or illegible		1.5	3.2	Visual
202.	Poor workmanship		2.5	3.6	Visual

NOTES:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.3 Inspection equipment. The inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein is described in the "Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method" columns in Table I and 4.4.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-W-63150 and 6.3 herein.

4.5 Methods of inspection

4.5. Assembleability. The blank firing attachment shall be assembled to an M85 machine gun or a fixture simulating the machine gun. Observation shall be made for compliance with the requirements specified in 3.3.

4.5.2 Functioning. The blank firing attachment shall be assembled to Caliber .50 M85 machine gun. Government standard M1A1 blank cartridges, linked with the M15A2 links, shall be used for the test. A belt consisting of eighty-five (85) cartridges shall be fired in approximately twenty (20) round bursts. Any assembly which fails to comply with the requirement specified in 3.4 shall be classed defective. All test results shall be recorded.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation and packaging.

5.1.1 Level A or B. (See 5.2.1).

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A or B. The blank firing attachment shall be packed in accordance with Packaging Data Sheet 9327231 and as specified in the contract.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with Packaging Data Sheet and P9327231 and as specified in the contract.

5.4 Shipping. When components from more than one lot are shipped at one time each lot shall be kept separate and the division between lots clearly indicated to prevent mixing of the lots in transit.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

b. Quantity required, delivery schedules, and cartridge and weapon system that Blank Firing Attachments are being procured for.

c. Quality Conformance Inspection, if other than specified in section 4 of this specification.

d. First Article Sample, if other than specified in section 4 of this specification.

e. Packaging requirements.

f. Responsibility for furnishing test weapons, ammunition and links.

g. Certificates of conformance for each lot or shipment of blank firing attachments.

6.3 Submission of inspection equipment designs for approval. Submit equipment designs as required to Commander, ARDEC, ATTN: AMSMC-QAF-I(D), Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000. This address will be specified on the Contract Data Requirements List DD Form 1423. Unless otherwise specified, data item DI-R-1714 will apply.

6.4 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks (or vertical lines) are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issues due to the extensiveness of the changes.

6.5 Drawings. Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament Research, Development and Engineering Center (ARDEC) may also include drawings prepared by, and identified as Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal, Picatinny Arsenal, US Army Armament Research and Development Command (ARRADCOM) or US Army Armament Research and Development Center (ARDC) drawings. Technical data originally prepared by these activities are now under the cognizance of ARDEC.

6.6 Subject term (key word) listing.

Blank Ammunition, Caliber .50, M1A1
Firing Attachment, Blank Ammo, M20
Link M15A2
Machine Gun, M85

Custodian:
Army-AR

Preparing activity:
Army-AR

(Project 1005-A714)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

COMMANDER
ARDEC
ATTN: AMSMC-QA
PICATINNY ARSENAL, NJ 07806-5000

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-F-63378A	FIRING ATTACHMENT, BLANK AMMO: M20

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T02:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.